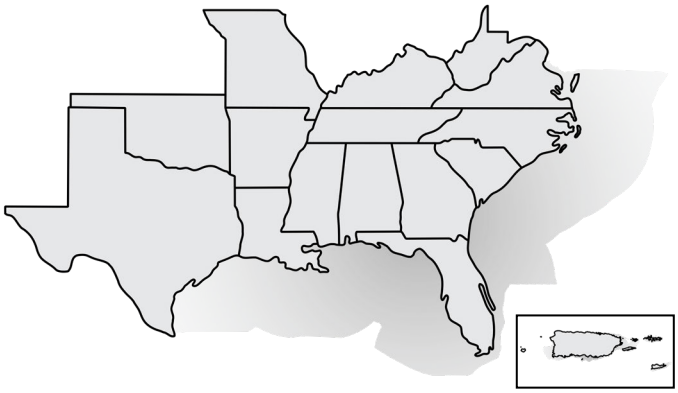


Photo by Gary Hartley, National Park Service

## *A Bold Vision*

A connected network of lands and waters that supports thriving fish and wildlife populations and improved quality of life for people




## *An Ambitious Goal*

A 10% or greater improvement in the health, function, and connectivity of Southeastern ecosystems by 2060

## *A Blueprint for Action*

A data-driven spatial plan that helps accelerate conservation action in the places where it will make the biggest impact



*"Year after year, SECAS continues to deliver on its promise of supporting a conservation vision for connected lands and waters across the Southeast and Caribbean."*

—Nicole Angeli, Chair of the SECAS Executive Steering Committee & Director of the Division of Fish and Wildlife at the U.S. Virgin Islands Dept. of Planning and Natural Resources

## Who We Are

SECAS is a regional conservation partnership that spans the U.S. Southeast and Caribbean. SECAS was started in 2011 by the states of the Southeastern Association of Fish & Wildlife Agencies and the federal agencies of the Southeast Natural Resource Leaders Group.

SECAS serves as a forum for collaboration and a hub for science and decision support. We help the conservation community rise to the challenges facing our natural and cultural resources by coordinating action and investment around a shared strategy.

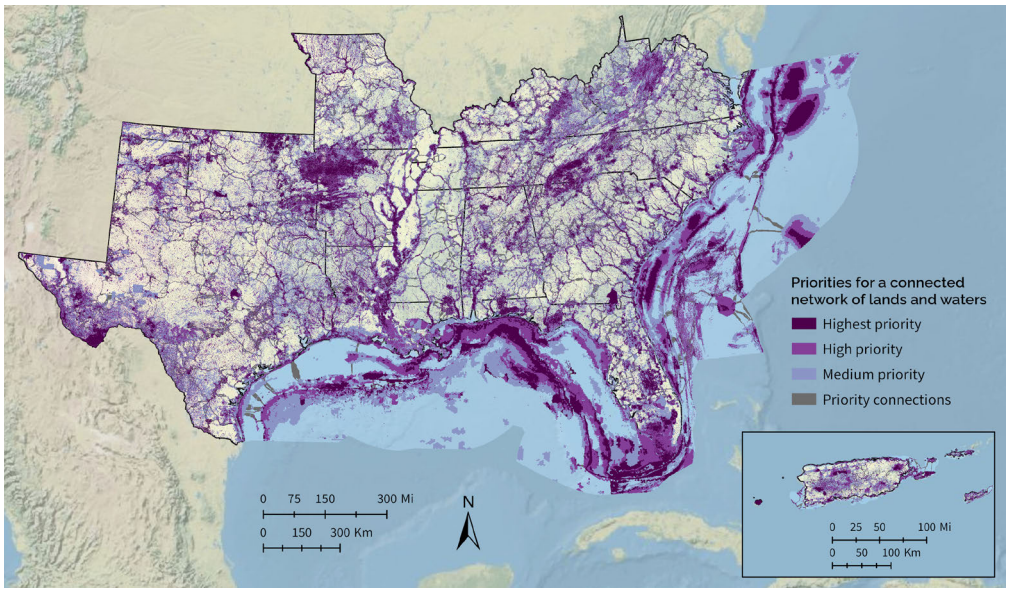
## What We Do

- We bring together state, federal, Tribal, nonprofit, private, and academic organizations to work toward a shared vision for the future
- We use regional metrics of ecosystem health, function, and connectivity to track and report on progress toward achieving the SECAS 10% goal
- We develop and support the Southeast Conservation Blueprint, a living, spatial plan that identifies priorities for a connected network of lands and waters

## Latest Accomplishments

- Helped shape 30-year conservation goals and align partner investments in the National Fish and Wildlife Foundation's Southern Habitats NextGen Business Plan
- Helped 10 coastal National Wildlife Refuges in SC and GA fulfill planning requirements and secure approval to expand their boundaries
- Helped partners use the Blueprint to strengthen grant proposals for conservation funding, for a total of $440 million brought in since 2014

# The Southeast Conservation Blueprint




*Blueprint Version 2026 identifies priority areas for achieving the SECAS vision of a connected network of lands and waters. Get started at [secassoutheast.org/blueprint](secassoutheast.org/blueprint).*

The Southeast Conservation Blueprint is the primary product of SECAS. The Blueprint is more than just a map. It's a living spatial plan to achieve the SECAS vision of a connected network of lands and waters across the Southeast and Caribbean. The Blueprint identifies priority areas based on a suite of natural and cultural resource indicators representing terrestrial, freshwater, and marine ecosystems. A connectivity analysis identifies corridors that link inland, coastal, and marine areas and span climate gradients. You can use these underlying layers to find your part of the Blueprint!

- The Blueprint identifies potential areas for a range of conservation actions, like landowner incentives, management, education, or protection.
- It's a work in progress that regularly incorporates new data, partner input, and information about on-the-ground conditions.
- The Blueprint provides a regional perspective and is intended to be used in combination with local data and knowledge.

## Get Help Using the Blueprint

Staff are available to answer questions and help you use the Blueprint to support a proposal or inform a decision. Your experience will guide future improvements and ensure the Blueprint reflects on-the-ground conditions.

We also welcome feedback on the Blueprint data and methods!

- Find contact information for Blueprint user support staff at [secassoutheast.org/staff](secassoutheast.org/staff)
- Or, contact Adam Malcomb at [adam_malcomb@fws.gov](mailto:adam_malcomb@fws.gov) and he'll put you in touch with the best person to help

## For More Information

- Visit [secassoutheast.org](secassoutheast.org)
- Subscribe to the monthly newsletter at the bottom of any page of the SECAS website
- Contact the Interim SECAS Coordinator: Louise Vaughn [louise_vaughn@fws.gov](mailto:louise_vaughn@fws.gov)

## Who's Using the Blueprint?



*The TN Wildlife Resources Agency explores using the Southeast Blueprint in their 2025 State Wildlife Action Plan. Photo by Ricky Martini with Walnut House event venue, used with permission.*

The Blueprint is helping 500+ people from 200+ organizations bring in new funding and inform decisions, including:

- A state wildlife agency strengthening a grant proposal to protect coastal wetlands and improve public access
- A broad coalition of military and conservation partners establishing a new Sentinel Landscapes Partnership
- A nonprofit supporting the reauthorization of a critical state conservation funding source
- A Tribe seeking funds to restore grasslands, rivercane, and aquatic connectivity on ancestral lands
- Longleaf pine partnerships prioritizing restoration and management actions
- A Council of Government helping a town refine its comprehensive plan
- A local Black heritage organization communicating the natural resource benefits of a cultural trail
- A watershed partnership developing a land protection strategy